

TIANZHOU (FRIDA) YAO

EDUCATION

- University of Washington, Seattle • Ph.D. in Economics • Sept 2019–present
Dissertation: Family Composition, Limited Commitment, and Female Labor Supply
Committee: Fabio Ghironi, Rachel Heath, Stephen Turnovsky, Stephan Siegel
- Jinhe Center for Economic Research, Xi'an Jiaotong University
B.A. in Mathematical Economics and Finance • June 2019
- The London School of Economics and Political Science • Summer School in Advanced Corporate Finance (Ph.D. Level, A) • Aug 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconomics • Public Finance • Household Economics • Labor Economics

RESEARCH PROJECTS

- **Intra-household Bargaining, Endogenous Divorce, and Female Labor Supply over the Life Cycle (Job Market Paper)**

Presented at the UW Economics MTI Brown-bag, Selected for AEA Annual Meeting Poster Session

Examines how bargaining within families and endogenous divorce affect female labor force participation by developing a structural life-cycle model with heterogeneity in education, non-labor income, and bargaining power. Calibrated to Japanese micro-data, the model aims to capture how social norms and motherhood penalties interact with tax regimes to shape macroeconomic outcomes.

- **Financial Literacy Confidence and Retirement Planning** (with Bingzheng Chen and Ze Chen)

Presented at the Retirement Planning Conference, under review: Journal of Pension Economics and Finance

The standard BIG THREE (compound interest, inflation, diversification) financial literacy indicators were enhanced by constructing an index of financial literacy confidence bias and showed that confidence bias significantly predicts private pension participation and retirement planning actions in Chinese panel data.

- **Prediction of RMB Exchange Rate from Policy Changes** (with Hao Song and Xintong Liu)

Presented at Jinhe Center for Economic Research

Used ARIMA and Markov-switching models with macroeconomic controls to analyze regime-dependent exchange rate dynamics under shifting monetary policies.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Instructor, Introduction to Microeconomics (Department of Economics)
- Instructor, Intermediate Microeconomics (Department of Economics)
- Instructor, Intermediate Macroeconomics (Department of Economics)
- Teaching Assistant, Investments (MBA course, Foster School of Business)
- Teaching Assistant, Decision Support Models (MBA course, Foster School of Business)

PROFESSIONAL ENGAGEMENT

- **Boston Consulting Group** • Bridge to BCG Program, Final-Round Interview (2025)
- **Edgeworth Economics, Washington, DC** • Ph.D. Summer Symposium (2023)
Participated in mock trial simulation (expert witness role) and antitrust case analysis in the Labor and IP divisions.
- **McKinsey & Company** • Financial Services (2019)
Contributed to “Insurance Technology Briefing Paper,” analyzing data from SMEs in the FinTech sector.
- **PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC)** • Assurance Division (2018)
Developed quantitative automation tools in Aura, PwC’s internal statistical system.
- **French Reinsurance Company** • Risk Management (2017)
Coordinated with Actuarial Department in developing company’s Quarterly Risk Report.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- AEA Annual Meeting Poster Session Selection • 2026
- Undergraduate Academic Excellence Award, Jinhe Center for Economic Research • 2019

tianzyao@uw.edu • 206-928-4760 • November 2025